

GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

The weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know

Saturday, 29 August 2026

Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 28 August US close. All times GMT+8.

1. Weekly Market Snapshot

Levels are Friday 28 August 2026 US-session closes. Weekly move is versus the prior Friday (21 August) close.

Instrument	Fri Close	Week	YTD	Note
S&P 500	7,711.76	+0.49%	+12.7%	Fourth up-week in five; grinding toward the 7,817 cycle high.
Nasdaq Composite	26,402.42	+0.85%	+13.6%	Led by software/mega-cap; semis wobbled into Friday.
Dow Jones	53,559.99	+0.53%	+11.4%	Quiet, steady; three-day win streak mid-week.
US 10Y yield	4.73%	-1 bp	--	Flat on the week but ~9 bp off Tuesday's 4.64% low.
US 2Y yield	4.34%	+10 bp	--	Hawkish repricing; 2s10s flattened to ~+39 bp.
Dollar (DXY)	~99.6	+0.7%	--	Firmer post-Jackson Hole; EUR/USD -0.8% to 1.1582.
Gold	\$4,529.9	-3.22%	high-teens %	Violent Friday reversal (-2.9%) as real yields & USD rose.
Silver	\$67.79	-2.51%	--	Followed gold lower; still above its 50-day.
Brent crude	\$88.10	-6.66%	--	War premium bled out on Hormuz reopening hopes.
WTI crude	~\$82.8	~-6%	--	Approx.; tracked Brent lower on de-escalation signals.
Bitcoin	\$77,820	-0.65%	--	Flat wk / wild intraweek (73k-80k-78k); ~38% off highs.
VIX	14.43	-0.70 pt	--	Complacent; no stress despite the commodity air-pocket.

Green = higher on the week, red = lower. The 2Y rise is shown red as a tightening signal; a falling 10Y/VIX is shown green where risk-supportive.

2. TL;DR

What defined the week

Equities ground higher on a **blockbuster NVIDIA print** — but the tape's real story was a **hawkish repricing**: a firm July PCE (3.7% headline / 3.3% core) and a hawkish Chair Warsh at Jackson Hole pushed the **2-year yield up 10 bp**, lifted the dollar, and knocked **gold -3.2%** and **Brent -6.7%**. Leadership rotated **out of NVIDIA/semis into software and the rest of mega-cap** (MSFT +6.3%, META +5.1%). Rate-cut hopes are gone; markets now price hike risk into year-end. Beneath a calm 14.4 VIX, the safe-haven and commodity trades took the pain.

3. The Big Picture — What the Week Meant

1. **NVIDIA delivered, and the AI capex story got bigger — not smaller.** Q2 revenue of \$96.2bn (+106% YoY) and guidance for ~70% growth next year, with CFO Kress flagging top-5 hyperscaler capex rising to \$1.3tn in 2027 from ~\$800bn in 2026. The stock jumped ~8% on the print, then gave back 4.6% Friday.

Read: The fundamental all-clear is intact; the price reaction was positioning, not thesis. “Sell-the-news” in NVDA is a rotation signal, not a top signal — stay long the AI complex but broaden beyond the one name.

2. **Jackson Hole went hawkish.** Chair Kevin Warsh used the symposium to flag still-elevated inflation and pointedly declined to offer dovish forward guidance. No pivot, no comfort.

Read: The Fed put is struck lower than the bulls hoped. Fade rate-cut trades; favour quality balance sheets and cash-flow over long-duration hope stories.

3. **Inflation is sticky where it hurts — services.** July PCE held at 3.7% headline and 3.3% core, both a touch hot; services prices re-accelerated to +0.3% while goods fell -0.1%.

Read: The last mile isn't happening on schedule. Real-asset hedges still make sense structurally, but this week showed they are not immune to a hawkish-Fed + strong-dollar squeeze.

4. **The safe-haven & commodity unwind was the week's biggest move.** Gold -3.2%, silver -2.5%, Brent -6.7%. Higher real yields, a firmer dollar, and fading Middle-East war premium hit everything defensive and inflation-linked at once.

Read: Crowded reflation/haven longs got flushed. This is a positioning cleanse inside an intact uptrend, not a regime change — but respect the momentum break in metals near-term.

5. **Leadership is broadening.** Software (MSFT +6.3%), platforms (META +5.1%, AMZN +3.0%) and even Apple (+3.4%) outpaced NVIDIA (+1.3%) and lagging Tesla (-3.9%). Friday's rotation dumped rate-sensitive REITs (-3.1%) and utilities.

Read: Healthier tape internally — breadth beyond one chip name is what sustains an index at highs. But watch the rate-sensitives: they are the tell if the 2Y keeps climbing.

6. **Growth is fine, not great.** Q2 GDP second estimate held at +1.5% annualised; jobless claims fell to 203k. Not a slowdown scare — which is exactly why the Fed can stay hawkish.

Read: A resilient-but-slows economy plus sticky inflation is the textbook late-cycle setup: own quality, keep duration short, and don't chase the most speculative cohort.

4. Rates, Currencies & Commodities

Rates & credit

The week's cleanest signal was at the **front end**: the **2-year yield rose 10 bp to 4.34%** while the **10-year finished flat at 4.73%** (having dipped to 4.64% Tuesday before PCE and Warsh reversed it). The 2s10s curve flattened to roughly +39 bp. This is a market pricing **less easing, not more** — the Fed funds target has sat at 3.50–3.75% since late 2025 and forwards now imply a year-end rate near 3.90%, i.e. a hike is more likely than a cut. Credit stayed calm: spreads near cycle tight, and a 14.4 VIX corroborates the “no stress” read.

Read: Short-duration and quality carry are the trades. The risk to watch is a further 2Y grind higher forcing a de-rating in the longest-duration equity pockets.

Currencies

The **dollar firmed** — DXY reclaimed ~99.6 from a mid-week low near 98.55 — as hawkish Warsh and hot data widened the rate-differential case. **EUR/USD fell 0.8% to 1.1582**; **USD/JPY pushed to ~160**, keeping the weak-yen theme and intervention-watch alive. A stronger dollar was the transmission belt into the metals and crude sell-off.

Read: Dollar strength is the swing factor for the whole risk complex here. A firmer USD caps gold and pressures EM/commodity FX — keep hedges on dollar-sensitive longs.

Commodities

A brutal week for the reflation basket. **Gold -3.2% to \$4,530** after a -2.9% Friday alone; **silver -2.5% to \$67.79**; **Brent -6.7% to \$88.10** and **WTI ~-6% to ~\$82.8**. Crude's fall was mostly geopolitical: hopes of a Strait of Hormuz reopening and

de-escalation signals let the war premium bleed out, even as sporadic shipping attacks continued. The EIA still sees Middle-East output below pre-conflict levels until early 2027 and Brent averaging ~\$87 in 2026.

Read: The metals break is a hawkish-Fed/strong-dollar event, not a demand collapse; structurally the bull case survives. Oil is a two-way headline machine — size for volatility, not direction.

5. Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Verification note: Hedgeye's proprietary daily Risk Ranges and its current-week Quad nowcast are subscriber-only and could not be independently verified for the week ending 28 August 2026. The regime read below applies Hedgeye's published *GIP* (Growth/Inflation/Policy) framework to this week's verified data; the range table is **desk-estimated** from realised weekly highs/lows and 50-/200-day trend anchors — treat it as indicative, not as Hedgeye's official levels.

Regime — where the Quads point

Hedgeye maps the rate-of-change of growth and inflation into four Quads. This week's data — **growth decelerating** (Q2 GDP +1.5% and softening) with **inflation sticky-to-firming** (PCE services re-accelerating) — sits squarely in the **Quad 3** neighbourhood (growth slowing, inflation elevated). The twist: Quad 3's classic playbook (gold #1, bonds bid, long-yields lower) was **overridden this week by a hawkish Fed** — a market pricing hikes crushed gold and lifted the front end. That policy overlay is the single most important variable to watch.

Immediate-term risk ranges (desk-estimated)

Instrument	Est. immediate-term range	TREND
S&P 500	7,610 – 7,815	Bullish
Nasdaq Comp.	25,900 – 26,700	Bullish
US 10Y yield	4.58% – 4.78%	Bullish (yields higher)
Gold	\$4,470 – \$4,700	Neutral / breaking
Silver	\$66.5 – \$72.0	Neutral
Brent	\$85 – \$95	Bearish
Bitcoin	\$72k – \$81k	Bearish TREND

Anchors: S&P 50-day 7,558 / 200-day 7,114; Gold 50-day 4,228 / 200-day 4,595; Silver 50-day 61.5; Brent 50-day 83.7; BTC 50-day 66.4k / 200-day 69.2k. "Bullish (yields higher)" means yields biased up — a headwind for duration.

Where we sit

Indices sit **above both their 50- and 200-day trend lines** — the equity TREND is bullish and intact. The stress is in **real assets and crypto**: gold has snapped back toward its 200-day, and Bitcoin remains below both averages with a bearish TREND. Net: stay constructive on U.S. large-cap equity, respect the broken momentum in metals, and keep the front-end of the curve as your risk gauge.

6. Mag7 Scoreboard

Prices are Friday 28 August close; week move vs 21 August; trailing P/E derived from TTM earnings yield.

Name	Price	Week	Mkt cap	P/E	Note
NVIDIA	\$217.55	+1.3%	\$5.27T	~27x	Blew out earnings, ran to \$228, then -4.6% Fri.
Apple	\$319.70	+3.4%	\$4.70T	~36x	Quiet outperformer; near 52-wk high \$344.
Alphabet	\$346.59	+0.5%	\$4.19T	~17x	Cheapest of the group; comm-services led Fri.
Microsoft	\$513.53	+6.3%	\$3.81T	~28x	Week's leader; software bid all week.
Amazon	\$266.43	+3.0%	\$2.87T	~21x	+4% Friday; retail + AWS momentum.
Meta	\$578.02	+5.1%	\$1.47T	~22x	Strong wk but ~27% below \$791 high.
Tesla	\$348.75	-3.9%	\$1.38T	~296x	Week's laggard; richest multiple in the group.

Leadership read: the tell this week was mega-cap **broadening**. Money left the crowded NVIDIA trade (net +1.3% despite a blowout) and spread into Microsoft, Meta, Amazon and even Apple. Tesla was the odd one out. The index making highs while the single most-owned name underperforms is a healthy internal signal, not a warning.

7. Positioning & Options

VIX 14.43, down 0.7 pt on the week and pinned in the low-14s — remarkably calm given gold fell ~3% and crude ~7% in the same five sessions. The volatility complex is treating the commodity air-pocket as idiosyncratic, not systemic. **Credit** was orderly: high-yield and investment-grade spreads held near cycle tights with no notable widening, consistent with the low-VIX signal.

Net read: positioning is calm-to-complacent. Equity vol is cheap insurance here — with a hawkish Fed and a September FOMC ahead, owning some downside protection into event risk is low-cost. There is no fear in the tape to fade, but little cushion if the 2Y keeps repricing.

8. Sector Rotation — Leaders & Laggards

Friday 28 August sector action (a rate-repricing day) illustrates the week's rotation:

Sector (Fri)	Change	Driver
Communication Services	+1.45%	Alphabet/Meta strength; the week's cleanest leadership.
Consumer Cyclical	+0.88%	Amazon-led; consumer resilient on low claims.
Consumer Defensive	+0.43%	Mild bid; not a fear rotation.
Basic Materials	+0.17%	Held despite the metals sell-off.
Financials	+0.01%	Flat; a steeper front-end a wash.
Industrials	-0.49%	Gave back with higher yields.
Technology	-0.62%	Semis/NVDA drag Friday even as software led the week.
Healthcare	-1.30%	Weak; no defensive haven bid.
Energy	-1.41%	Crude -7% on the week hit the complex.
Utilities	-1.63%	Rate-sensitive; hurt by the 2Y jump.
Real Estate	-3.12%	Biggest laggard; pure duration pain.

Read: Leadership is rotating toward growth/platforms and away from anything rate-sensitive. The Hedgeye-style tell: with the 2Y rising, own the balance-sheet-rich compounding and underweight REITs, utilities and long-duration defensives until the front end settles.

9. Corporate News — Key Earnings & Events

- **NVIDIA (NVDA)** — Q2 FY27 revenue \$96.2bn (+106% YoY, +18% QoQ); data-center revenue a record \$89.0bn (+117% YoY); non-GAAP EPS \$2.22; gross margin 75%. Guided ~70% revenue growth for the coming year (~2x consensus). The quarter's headline event.
- **Hyperscaler capex signal** — management framed top-5 hyperscaler capex rising to ~\$1.3tn in 2027 from ~\$800bn in 2026, underwriting the whole AI-infrastructure chain.
- **Chips & software also reported** — Marvell (MRVL), CrowdStrike (CRWD) and Salesforce (CRM) rounded out a heavy AI-adjacent earnings slate.
- **AI-buildout politics** — a two-week pullback in the AI trade was driven partly by local/political pushback against data-center buildouts in Texas, Tennessee, Pennsylvania and New York; a swing factor for power, land and semi names.
- **Mega-cap divergence** — Microsoft (+6.3%) and Meta (+5.1%) led; Tesla (-3.9%) lagged, keeping the “broadening beyond NVDA” theme intact.

10. Macro Data — Key Releases

- **US — July PCE (28 Aug):** headline 3.7% YoY (+0.2% MoM, above +0.1% est.); core 3.3% YoY (+0.2% MoM). Services +0.3%, goods -0.1%. **Net:** inflation is sticky in services — the hawkish case for the Fed.
- **US — Q2 GDP, 2nd estimate (26 Aug):** +1.5% annualised, unchanged from advance; consumer, exports and investment up, government spending down. **Net:** resilient but sub-2% — soft enough to slow, firm enough for the Fed to hold hawkish.
- **US — Initial jobless claims (wk to 23 Aug):** 203k, -4k, below the 208k estimate. **Net:** no crack in the labour market — removes the Fed's excuse to cut.
- **Policy backdrop:** Fed funds held at 3.50–3.75% since late 2025 (effective ~3.63%); Chair Warsh's hawkish Jackson Hole tone reinforced “higher-for-longer.” **Net:** forwards imply a ~3.90% year-end rate — the next move is as likely to be a hike as a cut.

11. Geopolitics

- **Strait of Hormuz / Middle East** — the strait remains effectively closed since the US/Israel-Iran conflict that began 28 February 2026 (~1/5 of global oil once transited it). This week, hopes of a reopening and de-escalation signals let crude's war premium deflate (Brent -6.7%), even as sporadic shipping attacks and a UAE suspension of financial dealings with Iran kept tail-risk alive. EIA sees regional output depressed until early 2027.
- **Russia-Ukraine** — still deadlocked in the ~4.5-year war. Kyiv handed Washington fresh proposals; Presidents Trump and Zelensky discussed reviving talks, but Ukrainian intelligence (18 Aug) said Russia shows no readiness for a ceasefire. No near-term breakthrough expected.
- **Prediction markets (Polymarket, late Aug):** September FOMC “no change” ~71%; a September hike ~40%; at least one 25 bp hike in 2026 ~67.5%. The crowd, like the bond market, has abandoned the cut narrative.

Read: Two live tails — an oil re-spike if Hormuz talks fail, and a hawkish Fed surprise — both point the same way: keep some energy/inflation optionality and short-duration ballast.

12. Beyond the Markets — Also Worth Knowing

Summits, conferences & talks

- The **Kansas City Fed's Jackson Hole Economic Symposium** was the week's set-piece; Chair Warsh's hawkish tone (covered above) was the market's takeaway.

Science & frontier research

- **Quantum vacuum, glimpsed:** a magnetar's colossal magnetic field appears to have revealed the vacuum-birefringence effect Heisenberg predicted ~90 years ago — empty space bending light.
- **Milky Way's deep past:** Hubble data show a dwarf-galaxy merger in the young Milky Way, extending our galaxy's known history ~1.8 billion years further back; JWST also spotted a bizarrely bright object from the early universe.

Space & frontier tech

- **GPS-free navigation:** NASA successfully tested satellites navigating without GPS, using other spacecraft and orbital debris as landmarks — a resilience milestone for space operations.
- **Roman Space Telescope** was enclosed in its Falcon Heavy fairing, nearing launch.

Weather & climate

- No single market-moving weather event this week; the energy story was geopolitical (Hormuz), not meteorological. Atlantic hurricane season remains the watch-item into September.

Water cooler

- **US Open tennis** — Fan Week and qualifying wrapped Friday 28 August at Flushing Meadows; the main singles draw begins Sunday 30 August in what is billed as the tournament's longest-ever edition (23 Aug–13 Sep).

13. Appendix — Stock Cards

Compact cards for the names materially discussed above. Prices Fri 28 Aug close; 52-week range and TTM valuation as at that date. Six-month trend described in words.

NVIDIA (NVDA)

Price \$217.55 (+1.3% wk)

Mkt cap \$5.27T

P/E (TTM) ~27x

Div \$0.28

52-wk range \$164.07 – \$236.54

Key date Q2 FY27 reported 26 Aug

6-month trend: Choppy but higher; pulled back with the AI trade over the prior fortnight, spiked ~8% on earnings to \$228, then sold off to \$217 on Friday's rotation. Still in the upper third of its 52-wk range.

Read: Fundamentals unimpeachable; Friday's drop was positioning. Own it, no need to press.

Apple (AAPL)

Price \$319.70 (+3.4% wk)

Mkt cap \$4.70T

P/E (TTM) ~36x

Div \$1.06

52-wk range \$225.95 – \$344.57

Sector Consumer Electronics

6-month trend: Steady climb through the year; now pressing toward the top of its range near the \$344 high. Low-beta ballast that quietly outperformed in a rotation week.

Read: The defensive mega-cap that isn't rate-sensitive; a comfortable core hold.

Alphabet (GOOGL)

Price \$346.59 (+0.5% wk)

Mkt cap \$4.19T

P/E (TTM) ~17x

Div \$0.85

52-wk range \$206.20 – \$408.61

Sector Comm. Services

6-month trend: Big six-month advance off the low-\$200s, then consolidating below the \$409 high. Comm-services led Friday, so it held up while semis slipped.

Read: Cheapest of the Mag7 on earnings; the value anchor of the group.

Microsoft (MSFT)

Price \$513.53 (+6.3% wk)

Mkt cap \$3.81T

P/E (TTM) ~28x

Div \$3.64

52-wk range \$349.20 – \$553.72

Sector Software

6-month trend: Strong uptrend; the week's mega-cap leader, breaking back toward its \$554 high as software caught a bid all week.

Read: The clearest beneficiary of the broadening; AI + enterprise-software leadership.

Amazon (AMZN)

Price \$266.43 (+3.0% wk)

Mkt cap \$2.87T

P/E (TTM) ~21x

Div None

52-wk range \$196.00 – \$287.20

Sector Consumer Cyclical

6-month trend: Grind higher over six months; +4% Friday put it near the top of its range. Retail + AWS momentum intact.

Read: Consumer-cyclical + cloud combo; resilient-consumer data is a tailwind.

Meta Platforms (META)

Price \$578.02 (+5.1% wk)

Mkt cap \$1.47T

P/E (TTM) ~22x

Div \$2.10

52-wk range \$520.26 – \$790.80

Sector Comm. Services

6-month trend: The laggard-turned-mover: well off its \$791 high (~27%) but rallied hard this week off the low-\$550s. Rebuilding after a deeper drawdown than its peers.

Read: Cheapest re-rating candidate if the ad cycle holds; watch the AI-capex burn.

Tesla (TSLA)

Price \$348.75 (-3.9% wk)

Mkt cap \$1.38T

P/E (TTM) ~296x

Div None

52-wk range \$297.38 – \$498.83

Sector Auto Manufacturers

6-month trend: Wide, volatile range over six months; sits in the lower-middle, well below the \$499 high. The week's Mag7 laggard.

Read: Richest multiple, thinnest earnings support; most vulnerable if risk appetite fades.

Other names referenced

- **Marvell (MRVL), CrowdStrike (CRWD), Salesforce (CRM)** — reported alongside NVIDIA as part of the AI-adjacent slate; drivers for the semis and software complex are discussed in Sections 8–9. Live levels not independently verified this week.

14. Sources & Disclaimer

Sources: Financial Modeling Prep (index, treasury, commodity, crypto, FX and company data); U.S. BEA (PCE, GDP); U.S. Treasury (yield curve); CNBC, Bloomberg, Reuters, The Motley Fool, Kiplinger, CBS News, TradingEconomics (market & macro coverage); NVIDIA Newsroom & SEC 8-K (earnings); Al Jazeera, Brookings, EIA (Strait of Hormuz / oil); Moscow Times, Al Jazeera, CFR (Russia-Ukraine); Polymarket (prediction-market odds); Barchart / FXStreet / Vantage (DXY); Hedgeye (GIP/Quad framework, publicly published); NASA, ScienceDaily, Universe Today (science & space); US Open / Tennis Majors (sport).

Figures are for the week ending Friday 28 August 2026 close unless noted; verify live prices before acting. WTI level, DXY level and Hedgeye risk ranges are approximate / desk-estimated and flagged as such in-text; the July PCE, Q2 GDP, jobless-claims, NVIDIA earnings and all index/rate/commodity/crypto closes were verified against primary or major-wire sources. This document is for information only and is not investment advice.